



Republic of the Philippines

DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY



DEC 29 2022

MEMORANDUM

TO : All Heads of DOST Regional Offices, RDIs, S&T Services,
Sectoral Councils, Collegial Bodies, and DOST Central Office

FROM : *Miguel*
DR. DIANA L. IGNACIO
Assistant Secretary for Administrative and Legal Affairs,
In charge of DOST Gender and Development Unit
and DOST-wide GAD Focal Person

SUBJECT : Use of Gender Fair Images, Content, and Language in Information,
Education and Communication Materials, and Official Documents

DATE : 28 December 2022

Pursuant to Sec. 13 of Republic Act 9710 or the Magna Carta of Women, which provides that gender-sensitive language shall be used at all times to further the avowed policy of abolishing the unequal structures and practices that perpetuate discrimination and inequality in society, and the Civil Service Commission Memorandum Circular No. 12, s. 2005 on the Use of Non-Sexist Language in All Official Documents, Communications, and Issuances, and in response to the Gender Mainstreaming Evaluation Framework (GMEF) assessment on the need to promote the use of non-sexist language and images, please ensure that these enumerated policy guidelines in the use of gender-fair images, content, and language in the Department of Science and Technology fora, media, official documents, communications, and issuances are adopted.

It is encouraged that all officials and employees shall exert conscious efforts to avoid implicit and explicit discriminatory language against women or men, and shall use gender-equality standards in the production and posting of DOST IEC materials; and non-sexist language in all fora, official documents, communications, and issuances and common day-to-day activities and work interactions.

Before production and posting, all IEC materials shall be assessed using the Self-Assessment Tools provided in the Philippine Commission on Women Gender-Fair Media Guidebook, which is a kit designed to serve as a reference for changing the perception of gender in media, recalibrating media practice to avoid gender discrimination, and consciously producing equalizing and empowering media content.

To promote gender sensitivity in the agency, gender-fair language shall be used in conducting fora and in preparing letters, memoranda, and other issuances. For other suggestions and examples on using non-sexist and gender bias-free language, all officials and employees shall refer to CSC MC 12, s.2005.

For your compliance.



Republic of the Philippines
Civil Service Commission
Constitution Hills, Batasang Pambansa Complex, Diliman 1126 Quezon City

100 Years of Service;
Civil Service at its Best,

Magmamayan Muna

MC No. 12, s. 2005

MEMORANDUM CIRCULAR

TO : ALL HEADS OF CONSTITUTIONAL BODIES; DEPARTMENTS, BUREAUS, OFFICES, AND AGENCIES OF THE NATIONAL GOVERNMENT; LOCAL GOVERNMENT UNITS; STATE UNIVERSITIES AND COLLEGES; GOVERNMENT-OWNED-OR-CONTROLLED CORPORATIONS WITH ORIGINAL CHARTER

SUBJECT : Use Of Non-Sexist Language In All Official Documents, Communications, And Issuances

Pursuant to CSC Resolution No. 050433 dated March 30, 2005, government officials and employees are encouraged to use non-sexist language in all official documents, communications, and issuances.

In line with the government's efforts to integrate women's concerns in its plans and programs through the years, the Civil Service Commission continuously undertakes gender mainstreaming activities, taking extra efforts in promoting gender-sensitivity in the bureaucracy. Beginning June 2000, gender and development (GAD) perspectives have been integrated in the conduct of civil service examinations partly through the use of non-sexist language in the test items. This has led to the Commission's active campaign on the use of gender-fair language.

Language is a very essential tool in communication. It articulates consciousness, reflects culture, and affects socialization. Hence, the need to recognize the importance of transforming language from traditional usage to a more liberating one, that which is gender-sensitive.

Since government employees and officials encounter gender issues everyday, the use of non-sexist language in preparing letters, memoranda, and other issuances, will encourage them to make a conscious effort to avoid implicit and explicit discriminatory language against women or men. This, in turn, will help promote gender-sensitivity in the bureaucracy.

Attached are some suggestions on how to use non-sexist language.

Please be guided accordingly.


KARINA CONSTANTINO-DAVID
Chair

March 31, 2005

cc: CSC
CSCD/HR/Adm



Republic of the Philippines
Civil Service Commission
Constitution Hills, Batasang Pambansa Complex, Diliman 1126 Quezon City

100 Years of Service;
Civil Service at Its Best,
Mamamayan Muna

Use of Non-sexist Language
X-----X

RESOLUTION NO. 050433

WHEREAS, Section (2), Article IX-B of the 1987 Constitution provides that the Civil Service embraces all branches, subdivisions, instrumentalities and agencies of the Government, including government-owned or controlled corporations with original charters;

WHEREAS, Section 12 (3), Chapter 3, Title I (A), Book V of the Administrative Code of 1987 provides that the Commission shall promulgate policies, standards and guidelines for the Civil Service and adopt plans and programs to promote economical, efficient and effective personnel administration in the government;

WHEREAS, the government has been exerting effort to integrate women's concerns in its plans and programs over the years;

WHEREAS, the Commission recognizes that since language articulates consciousness, reflects culture, and affects socialization, it is a very important tool in communication, and as such, it is important to transform language from traditional usage to a more liberating one, that which is gender-sensitive;

WHEREAS, requiring the use of non-sexist language in common day-to-day activities, such as preparing letters, memoranda, and other issuances, will encourage government employees and officials to make a conscious effort to avoid implicit and explicit discriminatory language against women or men, thereby helping promote gender-sensitivity in the bureaucracy;

NOW, THEREFORE, the Commission resolves to encourage all government officials and employees to use non-sexist language in all official documents, communications, and issuances.

Quezon City, MAR 30 2005


KARINA CONSTANTINO-DAVID
Chair


J. WALDEMAR V. VALMORES
Commissioner


CESAR D. BUENAFLOR
Commissioner

Attested by:


REBECCA A. FERNANDEZ
Director IV

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SOME SUGGESTIONS ON HOW TO USE NON-SEXIST LANGUAGE

1. ELIMINATE THE GENERIC USE OF *HE*, *HIS*, OR *HIM* UNLESS THE ANTECEDENT IS OBVIOUSLY MALE BY:

a. using plural nouns

TRADITIONAL: The lawyer uses his brief to guide him.
SUGGESTED: The lawyers use their briefs to guide them.

b. deleting *he*, *his*, and *him* altogether, rewording if necessary

TRADITIONAL: The architect uses his blueprint to guide him.
SUGGESTION: The architect uses a blueprint as a guide.

c. substituting articles (*a*, *an*, *the*) for *his*; using *who* instead of *he*

TRADITIONAL: The writer should know his readers well.
SUGGESTION: The writer should know the readers well.

d. using *one*, *we*, or *you*

TRADITIONAL: As one grows older, he becomes more reflective.
SUGGESTION: As one grows older, one becomes more reflective.

e. using the passive voice

TRADITIONAL: The manager must submit his proposal today.
SUGGESTION: The proposal must be submitted by the manager today.

2. ELIMINATE THE GENERIC USE OF *MAN*. INSTEAD, USE *PEOPLE*, *PERSON(S)*, *HUMAN(S)*, *HUMAN BEING(S)*, *HUMANKIND*, *HUMANITY*, *THE HUMAN RACE*.

TRADITIONAL: ordinary man, mankind, the brotherhood of man
SUGGESTION: ordinary people, humanity, the human family

3. ELIMINATE SEXISM IN SYMBOLIC REPRESENTATIONS OF GENDER IN WORDS, SENTENCES, AND TEXTS by:

a. taking the context of the word, analyzing its meaning, and eliminating sexism in the concept

TRADITIONAL: feelings of brotherhood, feelings of fraternity
SUGGESTION: feelings of kinship, solidarity

TRADITIONAL: the founding fathers
SUGGESTION: the founders, the founding leaders

TRADITIONAL: the Father of relativity theory
SUGGESTION: the founder of relativity theory, the initiator of relativity theory

b. finding precise words to delineate the thing itself from supposedly sex-linked characteristics

TRADITIONAL: Titanic was a great ship, but she now rests at the bottom of the sea.
SUGGESTION: Titanic was a great ship, but it now rests at the bottom of the sea.

TRADITIONAL:	"Don't let <u>Mother Nature</u> rip you off! <u>She's</u> out to kill your car's new finish... Stop <u>her</u> ..."
SUGGESTION:	"Don't let <u>Nature</u> rip you off! <u>It's</u> out to kill your car's finish... Stop <u>it</u> ..."

4. ELIMINATE SEXUAL STEREOTYPING OF ROLES BY:

a. using the same term for both genders when it comes to profession or employment

TRADITIONAL:	salesman, stewardess
SUGGESTION:	sales agent, flight attendant

b. using gender fair terms in lexical terms

TRADITIONAL:	sportsmanship
SUGGESTION:	highest ideals of fair play

c. treating men and women in a parallel manner

TRADITIONAL:	I now pronounce you man and wife.
SUGGESTION:	I now pronounce you husband and wife.

d. avoiding language that reinforces stereotyping images

TRADITIONAL:	a man's job, the director's girl Friday
SUGGESTION:	a big job, the director's assistant

e. avoiding language that catches attention to the sex role of men and women

TRADITIONAL:	working mothers, spinsters or old maids
SUGGESTION:	wage-earning mothers, unmarried women

TRADITIONAL:	busboys, chauvinist pigs
SUGGESTION:	waiters' assistants, male chauvinists

5. ELIMINATE SEXISM WHEN ADDRESSING PERSONS FORMALLY BY:

a. using Ms. instead of Mrs.

TRADITIONAL:	Mrs. dela Cruz
SUGGESTION:	Ms. dela Cruz

b. using a married woman's first name instead of her husband's

TRADITIONAL:	Mrs. Juan dela Cruz
SUGGESTION:	Ms. Maria Santos-dela Cruz

c. using the corresponding titles for females

TRADITIONAL:	Dra. Concepcion Reyes
SUGGESTION:	Dr. Concepcion Reyes

d. using the title of the job or group in letters to unknown persons

TRADITIONAL:	Dear Sir
SUGGESTION:	Dear Editor, Dear Credit Manager, Dear Colleague

